

Couples Questionnaire

Name: Lawrence Geoffrey Abraham, goes by "Geoff"
Age: 32.8
Do you currently live with your partner? **Y**
Marital status/history: Engaged to Mimosa, never prior married.

Please list any significant experiences or traumas in your history that could be helpful for me to know about (eg. Childhood abuse/neglect, domestic violence, physical/sexual assault, disasters/war, addictions, other mental or physical health issues, etc.)

My parents teased me -- maybe even ganged up on me as the only child -- but they also loved me deeply. Feeling protected, and protecting others brings up deep emotion for me.

I have struggled with feelings of pride and self-worth, perhaps related to the above.

I managed an eating disorder -- compulsive eating followed by a cleansing laxative -- for 18-24 months at the ages of 21-23. This may have been accompanied by depression.

Do you currently use any substances? If yes, please list what, how often, for how long, and whether it impacts your relationship.

MDMA, 4-8 times a year, for the last 4 years. LSD, a handful of times over 4 years. Usually, with Mimosa.

Note: I have occasionally struggled with Mimosa's regulation of alcohol consumption at social gatherings.

How would you like your relationship to improve and what would that look like?

I would like for us to:

1. achieve deeper trust and sense of emotional safety -- Gottman's bank account.
2. achieve a greater capacity for emotional fluidity and presence in the moment.
3. efficiently and thoroughly navigate subtle preferences in decision-making

What can you work on about yourself to be in better relation with Mimosa?

I can work on:

1. Speaking from a place of "I" always.
2. Better understanding, defining, and holding my boundaries and personal space.
 - a. related: voicing negative emotion in a sincere manner, and not as a tool
3. Dropping into a messy emotional presence -- the here and now.

What do you think Mimosa could work on in order to be in better relationship with you?

I believe Mimosa can work on:

1. Identifying and articulating her emotions (and preferences)
2. Having the courage to do the above, especially when it is difficult
3. Backing down from an entrenched position of pride